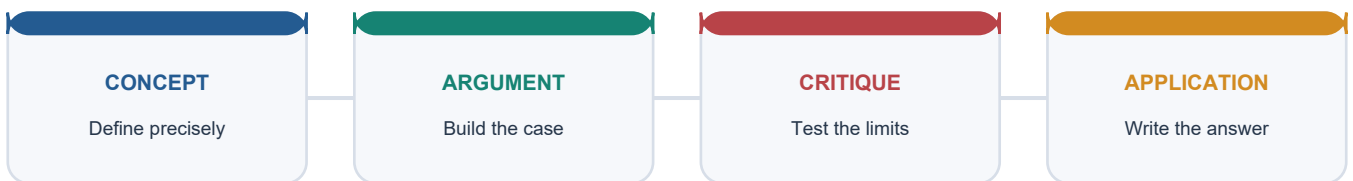


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Power, Authority and Legitimacy - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Power, Authority and Legitimacy - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 15 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Power**?

- A. the ability to produce intended effects or secure compliance; Gauba cites Russell, Dahl, Wiseman and MacIver to show its coercive and relational dimensions.
- B. A 1980 UN report figure on women's work-hours/income/property share is cited by Gauba as a (book-period) illustration of the scale of this exploitation (PDF p.316).
- C. adds hegemony, civil society and structures of legitimation to explain why capitalist rule survives through consent as well as coercion (PDF pp.306, 309-311).
- D. power regarded as rightful and therefore more stable and effective than naked coercion; Gauba's formula is authority = power + legitimacy (PDF p.303).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Power.
- **B:** B Attaches to Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately, not Power.
- **C:** C Attaches to Antonio Gramsci, not Power.
- **D:** D Attaches to Authority, not Power.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Power by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Influence**?

- A. power regarded as rightful and therefore more stable and effective than naked coercion; Gauba's formula is authority = power + legitimacy (PDF p.303).
- B. a softer capacity to shape choices or conduct without necessarily relying on sanctions; this is the useful exam distinction from coercive power.
- C. the first highlights domination by an agent over a subject; the second highlights the subject's capacity for resistance and self-development.
- D. for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Authority, not Influence.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Influence.
- **C:** C Attaches to Power over vs power to, not Influence.
- **D:** D Attaches to Hegemony, not Influence.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Influence by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Force / coercion**?

- A. identifies traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority; the last is central to the modern bureaucratic state (PDF p.303).
- B. trace political power to economic power rooted in ownership of the means of social production and class domination (PDF pp.308-309).
- C. compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).
- D. the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Max Weber, not Force / coercion.
- **B:** B Attaches to Marx and Engels, not Force / coercion.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Force / coercion.
- **D:** D Attaches to Legitimacy, not Force / coercion.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Force / coercion by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Legitimacy**?

- A. coercion belongs to state-enforced domination; hegemony works through consent cultivated in civil society (PDF pp.310-311).
- B. compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).
- C. identifies traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority; the last is central to the modern bureaucratic state (PDF p.303).
- D. the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Coercion vs hegemony, not Legitimacy.
- **B:** B Attaches to Force / coercion, not Legitimacy.
- **C:** C Attaches to Max Weber, not Legitimacy.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Legitimacy.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Legitimacy by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Authority**?

- A. power regarded as rightful and therefore more stable and effective than naked coercion; Gauba's formula is authority = power + legitimacy (PDF p.303).
- B. a softer capacity to shape choices or conduct without necessarily relying on sanctions; this is the useful exam distinction from coercive power.
- C. adds hegemony, civil society and structures of legitimation to explain why capitalist rule survives through consent as well as coercion (PDF pp.306, 309-311).
- D. for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Authority.
- **B:** B Attaches to Influence, not Authority.
- **C:** C Attaches to Antonio Gramsci, not Authority.
- **D:** D Attaches to Hegemony, not Authority.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Authority by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Hegemony**?

- A. a softer capacity to shape choices or conduct without necessarily relying on sanctions; this is the useful exam distinction from coercive power.
- B. for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).
- C. the first highlights domination by an agent over a subject; the second highlights the subject's capacity for resistance and self-development.
- D. compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Influence, not Hegemony.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Hegemony.
- **C:** C Attaches to Power over vs power to, not Hegemony.
- **D:** D Attaches to Force / coercion, not Hegemony.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Hegemony by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Power vs authority**?

- A. influence works by persuasion, prestige or agenda-shaping; force works by threat or sanction.
- B. the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).
- C. power can compel obedience; authority secures obedience as rightful and beneficial (PDF p.303).
- D. coercion belongs to state-enforced domination; hegemony works through consent cultivated in civil society (PDF pp.310-311).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Influence vs force, not Power vs authority.
- **B:** B Attaches to Legitimacy, not Power vs authority.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Power vs authority.
- **D:** D Attaches to Coercion vs hegemony, not Power vs authority.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Power vs authority by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Influence vs force**?

- A. the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).
- B. power can compel obedience; authority secures obedience as rightful and beneficial (PDF p.303).
- C. coercion belongs to state-enforced domination; hegemony works through consent cultivated in civil society (PDF pp.310-311).
- D. influence works by persuasion, prestige or agenda-shaping; force works by threat or sanction.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Legitimacy, not Influence vs force.
- **B:** B Attaches to Power vs authority, not Influence vs force.
- **C:** C Attaches to Coercion vs hegemony, not Influence vs force.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Influence vs force.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Influence vs force by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Political vs economic vs ideological power - political power uses state and public decision structures; economic power rests on control over production and.
- B. Power - adds hegemony, civil society and structures of legitimation to explain why capitalist rule survives through consent as well as coercion (PDF pp.306).
- C. Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately - power regarded as rightful and therefore more stable and effective than naked coercion; Gauba's formula.
- D. Arendt - a softer capacity to shape choices or conduct without necessarily relying on sanctions; this is the useful exam distinction from coercive power.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Records the association: Political vs economic vs ideological power is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Power is recorded with the ability to produce intended effects or secure compliance; Gauba cites Russell, Dahl, Wiseman and MacIver to show its coercive and relational dimensions (PDF pp.302-303).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately is recorded with A 1980 UN report figure on women's work-hours/income/property share is cited by Gauba as a (book-period) illustration of the scale of this exploitation (PDF p.316).
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Arendt is recorded with Arendt's own formula: power sustains the "public realm"; violence threatens it; "where genuine power is absent, violence may emerge to fill the gap," and "violence can destroy power; it is utterly incapable of creating it" (PDF pp.320-321).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Political vs economic vs ideological power; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Max Weber - for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).
- B. Coercion vs hegemony - coercion belongs to state-enforced domination; hegemony works through consent cultivated in civil society (PDF pp.310-311).
- C. Legitimacy - trace political power to economic power rooted in ownership of the means of social production and class domination (PDF pp.308-309).
- D. Force / coercion - the first highlights domination by an agent over a subject; the second highlights the subject's capacity for resistance and self-development.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Max Weber is recorded with identifies traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority; the last is central to the modern bureaucratic state (PDF p.303).
- **B:** B Matches the record: Coercion vs hegemony is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Legitimacy is recorded with the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Force / coercion is recorded with compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Coercion vs hegemony; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Influence - trace political power to economic power rooted in ownership of the means of social production and class domination (PDF pp.308-309).
- B. Hegemony - power regarded as rightful and therefore more stable and effective than naked coercion; Gauba's formula is authority = power + legitimacy (PDF p.303).
- C. Power over vs power to - the first highlights domination by an agent over a subject; the second highlights the subject's capacity for resistance and self-.
- D. Force / coercion - identifies traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority; the last is central to the modern bureaucratic state (PDF p.303).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Influence is recorded with a softer capacity to shape choices or conduct without necessarily relying on sanctions; this is the useful exam distinction from coercive power.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Hegemony is recorded with for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Power over vs power to is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Force / coercion is recorded with compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Power over vs power to; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Marx and Engels - for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).
- B. Force / coercion - coercion belongs to state-enforced domination; hegemony works through consent cultivated in civil society (PDF pp.310-311).
- C. Legitimacy - the first highlights domination by an agent over a subject; the second highlights the subject's capacity for resistance and self-development.
- D. Max Weber - identifies traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority; the last is central to the modern bureaucratic state (PDF p.303).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Marx and Engels is recorded with trace political power to economic power rooted in ownership of the means of social production and class domination (PDF pp.308-309).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Force / coercion is recorded with compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).
- **C:** C Not this pair: Legitimacy is recorded with the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).
- **D:** D Exact pair: Max Weber is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Max Weber; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Marx and Engels - trace political power to economic power rooted in ownership of the means of social production and class domination (PDF pp.308-309).
- B. Force / coercion - for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).
- C. Max Weber - coercion belongs to state-enforced domination; hegemony works through consent cultivated in civil society (PDF pp.310-311).
- D. Legitimacy - the first highlights domination by an agent over a subject; the second highlights the subject's capacity for resistance and self-development.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Exact pair: Marx and Engels is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Force / coercion is recorded with compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).
- **C:** C Not this pair: Max Weber is recorded with identifies traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority; the last is central to the modern bureaucratic state (PDF p.303).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Legitimacy is recorded with the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Marx and Engels; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately - the ability to produce intended effects or secure compliance; Gauba cites Russell, Dahl.
- B. Antonio Gramsci - adds hegemony, civil society and structures of legitimation to explain why capitalist rule survives through consent as well as coercion.
- C. Authority - for Gramsci, a form of rule apparently exercised with the consent of the ruled through cultural and ideological domination (PDF pp.306, 310).
- D. Influence - the first highlights domination by an agent over a subject; the second highlights the subject's capacity for resistance and self-development.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately is recorded with A 1980 UN report figure on women's work-hours/income/property share is cited by Gauba as a (book-period) illustration of the scale of this exploitation (PDF p.316).
- **B:** B Exact pair: Antonio Gramsci is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Authority is recorded with power regarded as rightful and therefore more stable and effective than naked coercion; Gauba's formula is authority = power + legitimacy (PDF p.303).
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Influence is recorded with a softer capacity to shape choices or conduct without necessarily relying on sanctions; this is the useful exam distinction from coercive power.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Antonio Gramsci; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Arendt - the ability to produce intended effects or secure compliance; Gauba cites Russell, Dahl, Wiseman and MacIver to show its coercive and relational.
- B. Robert Michels - (in Macpherson's company here, not a separate elite/class theorist): his 1925 Young India formulation of Swaraj as "the acquisition of the.
- C. Gaetano Mosca - Gaetano Mosca, in *The Ruling Class* (1896), argued every society divides into rulers and ruled.
- D. Steven Lukes - the "third dimension of power" - political power uses state and public decision structures; economic power rests on control over production.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Arendt is recorded with Arendt's own formula: power sustains the "public realm"; violence threatens it; "where genuine power is absent, violence may emerge to fill the gap," and "violence can destroy power; it is utterly incapable of creating it" (PDF pp.320-321).
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Robert Michels is recorded with Robert Michels, in *Political Parties* (1911), propounded the "Iron Law of Oligarchy": organisations - however democratic their founding aims - tend toward rule by a chosen few because growing size and complexity hand management to professional experts who become difficult to displace.
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Gaetano Mosca is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Steven Lukes - the "third dimension of power" is recorded with in *Power: A Radical View* (1974), Lukes goes a step further than Bachrach and Baratz: power-holders can shape and manipulate the very wants and preferences of others, such that people's "real interests" are suppressed without any visible conflict, decision or even agenda exclusion (PDF p.318).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Gaetano Mosca; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Gaetano Mosca - political power uses state and public decision structures; economic power rests on control over production and resources; ideological power.
- B. Steven Lukes - the "third dimension of power" - Arendt's own formula: power sustains the "public realm"; violence threatens it; "where genuine power is.
- C. Gandhi - in The Power Elite (1956), Mills replaces the Marxian "ruling class" (a single economic class) with "power elite" - three loosely interlocking.
- D. Robert Michels - Robert Michels, in Political Parties (1911), propounded the "Iron Law of Oligarchy": organisations - however democratic their founding aims.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Gaetano Mosca is recorded with Gaetano Mosca, in The Ruling Class (1896), argued every society divides into rulers and ruled, and that the ruling minority's defining strength is its organisational capacity ("organised minority" governing an unorganised majority), not mere intelligence as in Pareto.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Steven Lukes - the "third dimension of power" is recorded with in Power: A Radical View (1974), Lukes goes a step further than Bachrach and Baratz: power-holders can shape and manipulate the very wants and preferences of others, such that people's "real interests" are suppressed without any visible conflict, decision or even agenda exclusion (PDF p.318).
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Gandhi is recorded with (in Macpherson's company here, not a separate elite/class theorist): his 1925 Young India formulation of Swaraj as "the acquisition of the capacity by all to resist authority when it is abused" is Gauba's illustration of power redefined "from the point of view of the ruled" - akin to "speaking truth to power" (PDF p.323).
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: Robert Michels is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Robert Michels; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **C. Wright Mills** is associated with: in The Power Elite (1956), Mills replaces the Marxian "ruling class" (a single economic class) with "power elite" - three loosely interlocking groups (captains of industry, military leaders, prominent politicians) who occupy the pivotal command posts of modern American society and share social origins, culture and mutual reinforcement, without being reducible to one class (PDF pp.314-315).
2. **Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately** is associated with: Which issues never reach the agenda at all

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with C. Wright Mills does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Steven Lukes - the "third dimension of power"** is associated with: Arendt's own formula: power sustains the "public realm"; violence threatens it; "where genuine power is absent, violence may emerge to fill the gap," and "violence can destroy power; it is utterly incapable of creating it" (PDF pp.320-321).
2. **Arendt** is associated with: Arendt's own formula: power sustains the "public realm"; violence threatens it; "where genuine power is absent, violence may emerge to fill the gap," and "violence can destroy power; it is utterly incapable of creating it" (PDF pp.320-321).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Steven Lukes - the "third dimension of power" does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Foucault (optional at Section 6 level; developed further in Section 14)** is associated with: not present in Gauba's chapter.
2. **C.B. Macpherson** is associated with: Macpherson, in Democratic Theory - Essays in Retrieval (1973), distinguishes extractive power ("power over" others - the ability to use others' capacities for one's own purpose, historically the Western tradition's dominant focus from Machiavelli to James Mill) from developmental power (a person's ability to use their own capacities - rational understanding, moral judgment, aesthetic activity, love/friendship, productive labour - for self-chosen, self-fulfilling goals).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.

- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Foucault (optional at Section 6 level; developed further in Section 14) does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately** is associated with: (in Macpherson's company here, not a separate elite/class theorist): his 1925 Young India formulation of Swaraj as "the acquisition of the capacity by all to resist authority when it is abused" is Gauba's illustration of power redefined "from the point of view of the ruled" - akin to "speaking truth to power" (PDF p.323).
2. **Gandhi** is associated with: compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Feminist theory of power - reconstructed accurately does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Arendt** is associated with: Arendt's own formula: power sustains the "public realm"; violence threatens it; "where genuine power is absent, violence may emerge to fill the gap," and "violence can destroy power; it is utterly incapable of creating it" (PDF pp.320-321).
2. **Second (non-decision-making)** is associated with: the quality by which rules or decisions are treated as right, good or beneficial, producing willing compliance (PDF p.303).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Arendt does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **C.B. Macpherson** is associated with: the ability to produce intended effects or secure compliance; Gauba cites Russell, Dahl, Wiseman and MacIver to show its coercive and relational dimensions (PDF pp.302-303).
2. **Power** is associated with: the ability to produce intended effects or secure compliance; Gauba cites Russell, Dahl, Wiseman and MacIver to show its coercive and relational dimensions (PDF pp.302-303).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with C.B. Macpherson does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Gandhi** is associated with: (in Macpherson's company here, not a separate elite/class theorist): his 1925 Young India formulation of Swaraj as "the acquisition of the capacity by all to resist authority when it is abused" is Gauba's illustration of power redefined "from the point of view of the ruled" - akin to "speaking truth to power" (PDF p.323).
2. **Influence** is associated with: a softer capacity to shape choices or conduct without necessarily relying on sanctions; this is the useful exam distinction from coercive power.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Gandhi does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Second (non-decision-making)** is associated with: compliance secured through fear, sanctions or compulsion; Gauba says force is typically used when legitimacy fails (PDF pp.302-303).
2. **Force / coercion** is associated with: power can compel obedience; authority secures obedience as rightful and beneficial (PDF p.303).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Second (non-decision-making) does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Power, authority, legitimacy and influence all mean the same thing."**?

- A. Gauba's exact formula is authority = power + legitimacy; that distinction must be preserved (PDF p.303).
- B. He gives relative autonomy to superstructure and focuses on civil society, culture and consent (PDF pp.309-311).
- C. Later pluralists like Lindblom and Dahl admit business privilege and unequal political resources (PDF pp.318-319).
- D. She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's exact formula is authority = power + legitimacy; that distinction must be preserved (PDF p.303).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Gramsci only repeats classical Marxism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralism says nobody has unequal power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Arendt glorifies state force as power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Power, authority, legitimacy and influence all mean, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Weber's three authorities exist in pure form."**?

- A. Gauba's exact formula is authority = power + legitimacy; that distinction must be preserved (PDF p.303).
- B. Gauba notes Weber himself did not treat them as pure categories (PDF p.303).
- C. He gives relative autonomy to superstructure and focuses on civil society.
- D. Later pluralists like Lindblom and Dahl admit business privilege and unequal political resources (PDF p.318-319).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Power, authority, legitimacy and influence all mean the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba notes Weber himself did not treat them as pure categories (PDF p.303).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Gramsci only repeats classical Marxism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralism says nobody has unequal power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Weber's three authorities exist in pure form.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Pluralism says nobody has unequal power."**?

- A. She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321).
- B. He gives relative autonomy to superstructure and focuses on civil society, culture and consent (PDF pp.309-311).
- C. Later pluralists like Lindblom and Dahl admit business privilege and unequal political resources (PDF pp.318-319).
- D. Gauba's exact formula is authority = power + legitimacy; that distinction must be preserved (PDF p.303).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Arendt glorifies state force as power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Gramsci only repeats classical Marxism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Later pluralists like Lindblom and Dahl admit business privilege and unequal political resources (PDF pp.318-319).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Power, authority, legitimacy and influence all mean the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Pluralism says nobody has unequal power.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Gramsci only repeats classical Marxism.**"?

- A. Gauba's exact formula is authority = power + legitimacy; that distinction must be preserved (PDF p.303).
- B. Later pluralists like Lindblom and Dahl admit business privilege and unequal political resources (PDF pp.318-319).
- C. She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321).
- D. He gives relative autonomy to superstructure and focuses on civil society, culture and consent (PDF pp.309-311).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Power, authority, legitimacy and influence all mean the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralism says nobody has unequal power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Arendt glorifies state force as power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: He gives relative autonomy to superstructure and focuses on civil society, culture and consent (PDF pp.309-311).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Gramsci only repeats classical Marxism.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Arendt glorifies state force as power.**"?

- A. She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321).
- B. Later pluralists like Lindblom and Dahl admit business privilege and unequal political resources (PDF pp.318-319).
- C. He gives relative autonomy to superstructure and focuses on civil society, culture and consent (PDF pp.309-311).
- D. Gauba's exact formula is authority = power + legitimacy; that distinction must be preserved (PDF p.303).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralism says nobody has unequal power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Gramsci only repeats classical Marxism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Power, authority, legitimacy and influence all mean the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Arendt glorifies state force as power.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Pareto, Mosca and Michels all reach the same conclusion about elites."**?

- A. She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321); this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.
- B. Pareto and Mosca explain turnover among ruling minorities, whereas Michels explains why complex organisations tend toward oligarchic leadership even when.
- C. Gauba's three accounts extend to culture/symbolism, the household as an implicit labour contract, and the capitalism-patriarchy nexus in market work - a.
- D. Arendt's power is fundamentally collective/relational ("acting in concert" within a public realm), whereas Macpherson's developmental power is about an.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Arendt glorifies state force as power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Pareto and Mosca explain turnover among ruling minorities, whereas Michels explains why complex organisations tend toward oligarchic leadership even when founded democratically. These claims are distinct but not strict opposites: elites can circulate while rule remains oligarchic, and Gauba's objection means the iron law should not be applied uniformly (PDF pp.313-314).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Feminist power theory is only about domestic violence.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Macpherson's developmental power is just another name for Arendt's power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Pareto, Mosca and Michels all reach the same, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Macpherson's developmental power is just another name for Arendt's power."**?

- A. Gauba's three accounts extend to culture/symbolism, the household as an implicit labour contract, and the capitalism-patriarchy nexus in market work - a.
- B. Pareto and Mosca explain turnover among ruling minorities, whereas Michels explains why complex organisations tend toward oligarchic leadership even when.
- C. Arendt's power is fundamentally collective/relational ("acting in concert" within a public realm), whereas Macpherson's developmental power is about an.
- D. She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321); this option applies the proposition as a complete explanation.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Feminist power theory is only about domestic violence.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Pareto, Mosca and Michels all reach the same conclusion about elites.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Arendt's power is fundamentally collective/relational ("acting in concert" within a public realm), whereas Macpherson's developmental power is about an individual's capacity for self-realisation (rational, moral, aesthetic, productive) - related "power to" themes, but built on different units of analysis (group vs person) (PDF pp.320-322).

- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Arendt glorifies state force as power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Macpherson's developmental power is just another, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Feminist power theory is only about domestic violence.**"?

- A. Later pluralists like Lindblom and Dahl admit business privilege and unequal political resources (PDF pp.318-319); this formulation is presented as sufficient for the classification.
- B. She distinguishes genuine collective power from violence and treats violence as destructive of power (PDF pp.320-321); no additional distinction is made within this interpretation.
- C. He gives relative autonomy to superstructure and focuses on civil society, culture and consent (PDF pp.309-311); the rival mechanism is treated as non-decisive in this account.
- D. Gauba's three accounts extend to culture/symbolism, the household as an implicit labour contract, and the capitalism-patriarchy nexus in market work - a.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralism says nobody has unequal power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Arendt glorifies state force as power.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Gramsci only repeats classical Marxism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's three accounts extend to culture/symbolism, the household as an implicit labour contract, and the capitalism-patriarchy nexus in market work - a structural, not only interpersonal, claim (PDF pp.315-316).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Feminist power theory is only about domestic, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish power, authority, legitimacy and influence. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of power, authority, legitimacy and influence in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Power and Influence, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that introduction: The four concepts describe different mechanisms of securing effects or compliance and should not be used as interchangeable synonyms.

Model answer (146 words):

Introduction: The four concepts describe different mechanisms of securing effects or compliance and should not be used as interchangeable synonyms. Core analysis: Power is the capacity to produce intended effects or make others comply, whether through resources, sanctions, organisation or control. Influence is a softer capacity to shape conduct through persuasion, prestige or agenda-setting without direct compulsion. Legitimacy is the accepted rightfulness or beneficial character of a rule or decision. Authority is legitimate power: Gauba's formula, authority equals power plus legitimacy, explains why willing compliance is normally more durable and less costly than naked force. Influence can rest on hidden asymmetry, legality can exist without legitimacy, and accepted authority can be challenged where preferences themselves have been shaped by domination. Conclusion: Power names capacity, influence names non-coercive shaping, legitimacy names accepted rightfulness, and authority joins power to legitimacy; collapsing them conceals how compliance is actually secured.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Power and Influence), converts that evidence into analysis of power, authority, legitimacy and influence, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that introduction: The four concepts describe different mechanisms of securing effects or compliance and should not be used as interchangeable synonyms. At 146 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Explain Weber's three types of authority and their limits as pure categories. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive explain requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of weber's three types of authority and their limits as pure categories in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Weber, Core and Traditional, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority identify rival bases of legitimate obedience, but actual regimes combine them and must still answer whether accepted rule is justified rather than merely believed.

Model answer (146 words):

Introduction: Weber classifies authority by the belief that makes obedience appear rightful rather than by the policy goals of a regime. Core analysis: Traditional authority rests on established custom and inherited status; hereditary or dynastic rule is the standard illustration. Charismatic authority rests on belief in the extraordinary qualities of a leader and is unstable unless routinised into offices or tradition. Legal-rational authority rests on impersonal rules, competence and office: a civil servant, judge or elected official is obeyed because the office and procedure are accepted as valid. It is central to modern bureaucracy because obedience attaches to a rule-bound role rather than a person. Classification explains legitimacy beliefs; it does not prove their moral adequacy. Conclusion: Traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority identify rival bases of legitimate obedience, but actual regimes combine them and must still answer whether accepted rule is justified rather than merely believed.

Why this earns marks: it obeys explain instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Weber, Core and Traditional), converts that evidence into analysis of weber's three types of authority and their limits as pure categories, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Traditional, charismatic and legal-rational authority identify rival bases of legitimate obedience, but actual regimes combine them and must still answer whether accepted rule is justified rather than merely believed. At 146 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Critically examine elite theory with reference to Pareto, Mosca, Michels and C. Wright Mills. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine elite theory with reference to Pareto, Mosca, Michels and C. Wright Mills in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Elite, Core and Pareto, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Elite theory reveals organised minority rule and command positions, but circulation of leaders, oligarchic organisation and interlocking institutional elites are distinct claims whose empirical reach must remain qualified.

Model answer (142 words):

Introduction: Elite theory challenges the democratic image of equal popular rule by arguing that organised minorities occupy decisive positions in every complex society. Core analysis: Pareto distinguishes governing and non-governing elites and explains change through circulation, including the contrasting styles of lions and foxes. Mosca locates minority advantage in organisation: an organised minority governs an unorganised majority, though leadership can emerge from different strata. Michels shifts attention from personnel to organisation. Size, expertise and managerial indispensability generate an oligarchic tendency even in parties founded democratically. Gauba's own objection to Michels is decisive: oligarchy varies across organisations, so the iron law is a strong tendency to test, not proof that democratic contestability is impossible. Conclusion: Elite theory reveals organised minority rule and command positions, but circulation of leaders, oligarchic organisation and interlocking institutional elites are distinct claims whose empirical reach must remain qualified.

Why this earns marks: it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Elite, Core and Pareto), converts that evidence into analysis of examine elite theory with reference to Pareto, Mosca, Michels and C. Wright Mills, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Elite theory reveals organised minority rule and command positions, but circulation of leaders, oligarchic organisation and interlocking institutional elites are distinct claims whose empirical reach must remain qualified. At 142 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Does pluralism adequately explain political power? Discuss through the three-dimensional power ladder. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of pluralism adequately explain political power? Discuss through the three-dimensional power ladder in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Pluralism, Core and Dahl's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that the third dimension remains a contested hypothesis rather than a proven diagnosis.

Model answer (250 words):

Introduction: Pluralism explains power through competition among multiple groups, but its adequacy depends on whether power is limited to visible decisions. Core analysis: The first dimension studies observable conflict: who participates, whose preference prevails and whether different groups win on different issues. Dahl's polyarchic model captures bargaining and the absence of one permanently victorious actor. The second dimension, associated with Bachrach and Baratz, asks which issues are excluded before decision-making begins; agenda control is power even without a recorded contest. Lukes's third dimension goes further by hypothesising that institutions and ideology can shape wants so deeply that subordinate groups neither articulate conflict nor recognise an excluded interest. Gramsci's hegemony supplies a related mechanism of consent formation. Further development: The dimensions are not simply three interchangeable examples. The first can be studied through visible decisions, the second through excluded issues and institutional rules, and the third through the disputed counterfactual of what people would want under less domination. Because that counterfactual is difficult to establish, third-dimensional analysis should use second-dimensional evidence where possible: defaults, suppressed alternatives, asymmetrical information and barriers to contestation. This preserves Lukes's critical insight without immunising it from evidence. Yet the third dimension risks unfalsifiability: it should be presented as a contested hypothesis supported through observable agenda, default and institutional mechanisms, not asserted as a proven real interest. Conclusion: Pluralism captures visible group competition, but agenda exclusion and preference shaping reveal progressively deeper forms of domination; the third dimension remains a contested hypothesis rather than a proven diagnosis.

Why this earns marks: it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Pluralism, Core and Dahl's), converts that evidence into analysis of pluralism adequately explain political power? Discuss through the three-dimensional power ladder, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that the third dimension remains a contested hypothesis rather than a proven diagnosis. At 250 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Marxist, Gramscian, feminist and pluralist accounts of the location of power. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of marxist, Gramscian, feminist and pluralist accounts of the location of power in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Marx and Engels, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that these additions show that political analysis must ask not only who dominates, but what collective and personal capacities institutions enable.

Model answer (240 words):

Introduction: The four perspectives disagree not only about who possesses power but about the institutions and mechanisms through which domination is reproduced. Core analysis: Marx and Engels locate political power in economic ownership and class control of social production; state power protects the structural conditions of accumulation. Gramsci preserves material conflict but gives relative autonomy to civil society, where schools, churches, associations and intellectual leadership organise hegemony and consent. Feminist theory relocates power into the supposedly private sphere: culture, sexuality, household labour and labour-market segmentation reproduce patriarchy alongside capitalism. Pluralism instead disperses power among autonomous groups and treats government as mediator, though Dahl and Lindblom later acknowledge unequal political resources and business privilege. Bachrach-Baratz and Lukes show why visible competition may overlook agenda exclusion and preference shaping. Further development: Arendt and Macpherson provide a constructive correction to accounts centred on domination. Arendt locates power in collective action and distinguishes it from violence; Macpherson distinguishes extractive power over others from developmental power to use one's capacities. Gandhi's swaraj as the capacity to resist abused authority supplies an Indian bridge. These additions show that political analysis must ask not only who dominates, but what collective and personal capacities institutions enable. Critical evaluation: No one location is sufficient. Analysis should connect resources, institutions, ideology and resistance. Conclusion: These perspectives locate power in ownership, hegemony, patriarchy and group competition respectively, so a complete account must connect material resources, consent, intimate structures and institutional contestability.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Marx and Engels), converts that evidence into analysis of marxist, Gramscian, feminist and pluralist accounts of the location of power, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that these additions show that political analysis must ask not only who dominates, but what collective and personal capacities institutions enable. At 240 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: How does digital surveillance transform power, authority and legitimacy? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive how requires the answer to state the mechanism step by step and show what each step produces. Fix the boundary of does digital surveillance transform power, authority and legitimacy in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Digital, Core and Foucault's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that lukes's third dimension remains a hypothesis;.

Model answer (229 words):

Introduction: Digital surveillance is politically significant because it produces effects without relying only on visible command, extending classical power into data, prediction and privately governed infrastructure. Core analysis: Foucault's panopticism identifies the self-policing mechanism generated when the watched cannot know when observation occurs. Contemporary digital power adds asymmetric knowledge, ranking and visibility control, behavioural prediction, pre-emption and automated discretion. These mechanisms map onto the three-dimensional ladder: decisions allocate outcomes, architecture keeps issues or speakers off the agenda, and personalised environments may shape preferences. Zuboff's surveillance-capitalism vocabulary and Pariser's filter-bubble warning are extensions beyond Gauba, not book quotations. The public-private boundary complicates accountability because contractual platforms may perform speech, visibility and adjudicative functions that resemble government without fitting ordinary electoral control. Further development: The February 2026 M.A.N.A.V. vision at the India AI Impact Summit provides a cautious official anchor because it joins moral systems, accountable governance and valid or legitimate systems to AI. It can be used as a public standard against which digital power is judged, not as proof that

every deployed system meets that standard. Lukes's third dimension remains a hypothesis; analysis should begin with observable defaults, exclusions and review failures. Conclusion: Digital surveillance extends power through asymmetric knowledge, ranking and anticipation, but it becomes authority only where consent is meaningful, decisions are contestable and public or private power is answerable under rights-respecting rules.

Why this earns marks: it obeys how instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Digital, Core and Foucault's), converts that evidence into analysis of does digital surveillance transform power, authority and legitimacy, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that lukes's third dimension remains a hypothesis;. At 229 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
